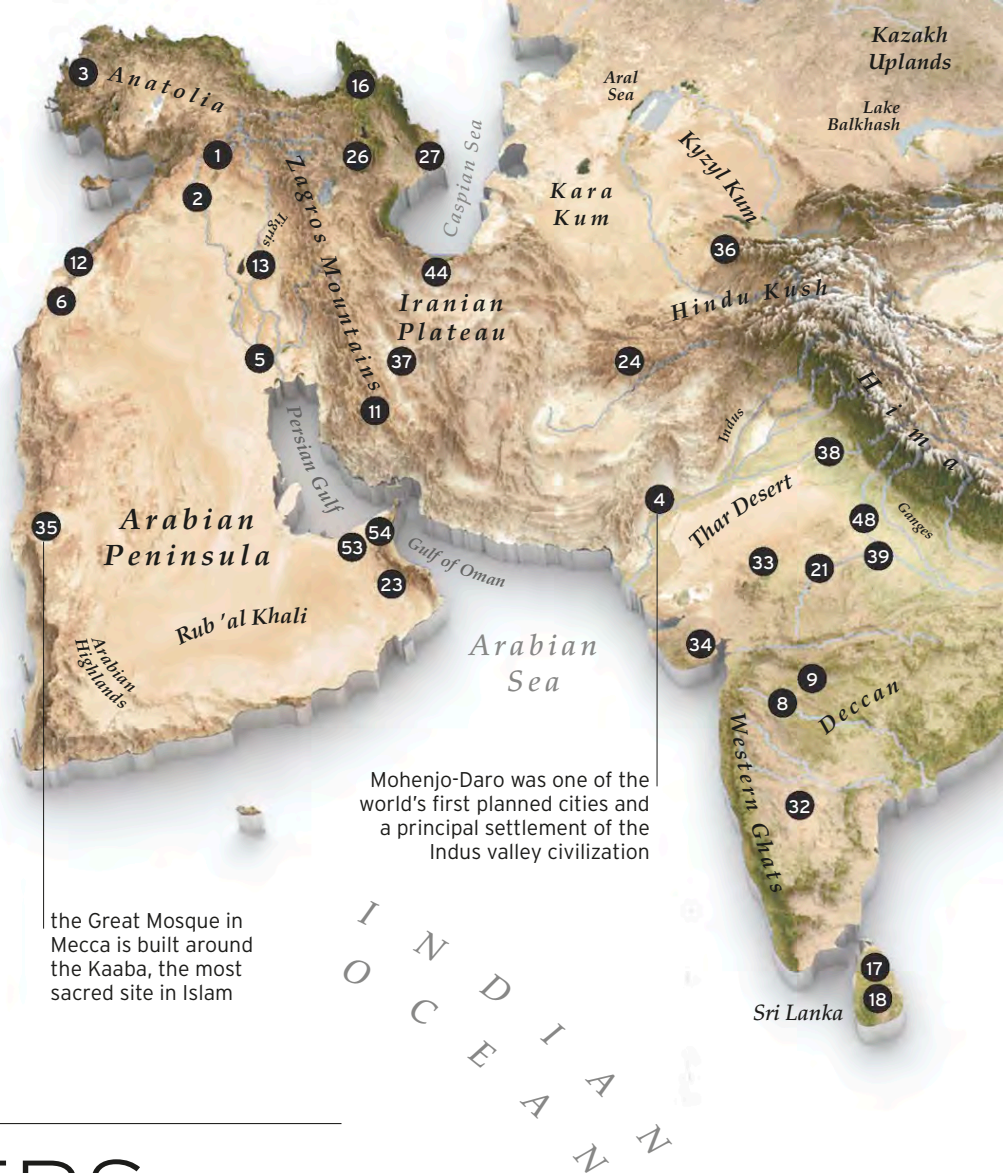


KEY SITES

- | | | |
|--|-------------------------------|--|
| 1 Göbekli Tepe | 20 Candi Prambanan | 39 Taj Mahal |
| 2 Palmyra | 21 Chand Baori | 40 Toshogu Shrine |
| 3 Ephesus | 22 Temples of Bagan | 41 Potala Palace |
| 4 Mohenjo-Daro | 23 Bahla Fort | 42 Paro Taktsang |
| 5 Ziggurat of Ur | 24 Minaret of Jam | 43 The Grand Palace |
| 6 Petra | 25 Angkor Wat | 44 Pink Mosque |
| 7 Terracotta Army | 26 Monastery of Geghard | 45 Royal Exhibition Building |
| 8 Ajanta Caves | 27 Palace of the Shirvanshahs | 46 Sydney Harbour Bridge |
| 9 Ellora Caves | 28 Himeji Castle | 47 Temple of the Golden Pavilion |
| 10 The Hanging Temple | 29 Gyeongbokgung Palace | 48 Lotus Temple |
| 11 Persepolis | 30 Forbidden City | 49 Sydney Opera House |
| 12 Dome of the Rock | 31 Great Wall of China | 50 National Assembly Building of Dhaka |
| 13 Great Mosque of Samarra | 32 Hampi | 51 Wat Rong Khun |
| 14 Leshan Giant Buddha | 33 Mehrangarh Fort | 52 Akashi Kaikyo Bridge |
| 15 Borobudur | 34 Palitana | 53 Sheikh Zayed Mosque |
| 16 Vardzia | 35 Great Mosque of Mecca | 54 Burj Khalifa |
| 17 Dambulla Cave Temples | 36 Registan Square | 55 Gardens by the Bay |
| 18 Sacred City of Kandy | 37 Shah Mosque | 56 Tianjin Binhai Library |
| 19 Ancient Buildings of Wudang Mountains | 38 Golden Temple of Amritsar | |



EMPIRE BUILDERS AND INNOVATORS

Asia and Australasia

As waves of political and religious empire builders moved eastward across the vast Asian continent and south to Australasia, they spread engineering techniques and stylistic influences and unleashed building ingenuity. Persian taste and knowledge migrated to the Indian subcontinent in the 6th century, followed by Islamic arts and architecture, as the Umayyad Dynasty expanded its reach to India.

In turn, India's religions, Hinduism and Buddhism, introduced new aesthetic ideals to China, Japan, and Southeast Asia, informing the architecture of temples, palaces, and shrines. In recent times, devotion to the idea of sustainability has launched a new generation of intelligent, energy-saving wonders across Asia and Australasia.

HINDUISM SPREADS THROUGH SOUTHEAST ASIA

6TH-14TH CENTURY CE

As traders from India expanded their business in Southeast Asia, they brought Hindu culture with them, notably the religious architecture of the Indian temple. The building styles merged with local traditions, evident in the step pyramids of the Khmer empire and the Indonesian temple of Prambanan.

25 ANGKOR WAT



THE MING DYNASTY INSPIRES CULTURAL GROWTH

1368-1644

Political stability in China during the Ming dynasty enabled large-scale feats of construction, from the Forbidden City and the Great Wall to the Chang Mansion near Myanmar. These structures expressed the reassertion of imperial power after Mongol rule through their monumental scale and the strict visual hierarchy of classical Chinese architecture.



30 FORBIDDEN CITY

URBAN PLANNING AND IDEALISM

The earliest forms of urban planning and advanced stone construction emerged in the Fertile Crescent and Indus Valley. In East Asia, there is also evidence of early urban planning in China, and Buddhism inspired architecture that sought to replicate heaven on Earth. Colonialism left its mark on Southeast Asia and Australasia, where ecologically sensitive building is now considered critical.